

TEAM NOX
TEAM HANDBOOK
35707 / 11702





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ABOUT THE HANDBOOK

This handbook is intended to contain the information needed for all **FRC 11702** and **FTC 35707** team members to understand the administrative and logistical procedures for **FRC Team 11702** and **FTC 35707** Team Nox. It is updated yearly by Core Leadership to accurately represent current standards.

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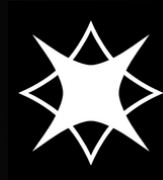


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1. ABOUT FIRST

What is FIRST? FIRST, **For Inspiration and Recognition of Science and Technology**, is a non-profit organization dedicated to inspiring young people to be leaders and innovators in science and technology. Through programs such as FIRST Robotics Competition and FIRST Lego League, students are encouraged to excel in the areas of science, technology, engineering, and mathematics. FIRST was founded in 1989 by Dean Kamen (inventor of the Segway and the insulin pump) and has since become an international organization that has reached hundreds of thousands of students from elementary school through high school. For more information, visit <https://www.firstinspires.org/>. **ALL STUDENTS MUST HAVE A FIRST INSPIRES ACCOUNT IN ORDER TO PARTICIPATE IN TEAM ACTIVITIES AND COMPETITIONS!**

1.1 ABOUT FTC

The FIRST Tech Challenge (FTC) is the middle level of FIRST robotics competition. FTC is designed for students in grades 7-12, or about age 12-18, to learn and develop skills including building, programming, and competing with robots. Teams must develop innovative designs, code their robots, and strategically plan and problem-solve their way through a competitive game. Students are supported by a group of mentors to help them learn to engineer, program, and manage their teams. The FIRST Tech Challenge is much more than learning to play with robots; it helps to promote creativity, teamwork, and leadership while teaching students about science, technology, engineering, and math.

1.2 ABOUT FRC

The FIRST Robotics Competition (FRC) is FIRST's flagship robotics program where high school students must design and build programs and compete with robots in a game based engineering challenge. Students on teams work together to create machines and gain hands-on experience in mechanical design, software, electronics, leadership, and project management, while learning how to approach obstacles in order to overcome them. Teams of students are guided by their mentors through the process of building robots to then compete against others and get hands-on experience. Not only does the FRC teach students about robotics, but it also helps students develop teamwork, creativity, and problem solving skills and inspire them to go into STEM fields and become innovators.





1. ABOUT FIRST

1.3 FIRST CORE VALUES

The values of the FIRST Core Values are key components of the FIRST community, and it provides guidance to students on how to build, design, compete, and work with each other. These values inspire learners to develop skills, demonstrate leadership, use creativity, and grow responsibly while having fun. The company uses these core values to develop challenges, competitions, outreach events, and teamwork instructions which are used by teams to work together to achieve their goals.

- **Discovery**
 - FIRST utilizes Discovery by having students go deeper into the subject of STEM, while learning new skills and taking on challenges within their own engineering process.
- **Innovation**
 - FIRST incorporates Innovation by challenging teams to think creatively, design unique solutions, and apply engineering principles to build robots and strategies that solve complex problems.
- **Impact**
 - FIRST incorporates Impact by allowing students to use what they've learned to lead to others and encourage them and their communities to make a positive change.
- **Inclusion**
 - FIRST incorporates Inclusion by making sure people from all walks of life feel welcome to attend, participate, and perform as well as they can for the team.
- **Teamwork**
 - FIRST incorporates Teamwork by teaching students to collaborate, communicate effectively, and combine their different skills and perspectives to achieve a shared goal.
- **Fun**
 - FIRST incorporates Fun by providing fun experiences for the students such as learning, building, competing, and connecting with teammates and with the FIRST community

1.4 KEY PHILOSOPHIES

The key philosophies of FIRST guide how teams learn, compete, and interact with one another by emphasizing collaboration, innovation, leadership, and creating a positive impact through STEM. These principles encourage students to not only build successful robots but also develop the skills, values, and mindset needed to become future innovators and leaders.

- **Gracious Professionalism®**
 - Gracious Professionalism® encourages teams to compete with excellence while treating others with respect, kindness, and support both on and off the field.
- **Coopertition®**
 - Coopertition® encourages teams to compete while collaborating, sharing knowledge, and helping one another to strengthen the entire FIRST community.



2. TEAM BACKGROUND

2.1 MISSION, MOTTO, & VISION

2.1.1 MISSION

We are Team Nox. Our mission is to create a communal space that is safe, student-led, and welcoming, where every student has the opportunity to explore STEM and develop a sense of belonging. This team, founded on the ideology that innovation not only develops but thrives in an inclusive environment, strives to foster a supportive space for students who have had no prior experience in FIRST, or have been exposed, but have felt undervalued, underrepresented, or unempowered within their community.

2.1.2 MOTTO

**“IGNITING PASSION. INNOVATING
SOLUTIONS. INSPIRING LEADERS.”**

2.1.3 VISION

We strive to create a citywide STEM pipeline that empowers learners of all ages through engineering and robotics education, expands access to hands-on learning, develops a highly competitive robotics program, and inspires the next generation of innovators across New York City.

2.2 WHAT WE DO

2.2.1 IGNITE

We ignite curiosity and passion for STEM by providing students with hands-on experiences that encourage exploration, creativity, and discovery. Through mentorship, teamwork, and real-world engineering challenges, we inspire students to develop confidence, embrace lifelong learning, and realize their potential as future innovators and leaders.

2.2.2 INNOVATE

We foster innovation by encouraging students to design, prototype, test, and refine creative engineering solutions. Through hands-on problem-solving, collaboration, and continuous iteration, we transform ideas into reality while developing the technical and critical thinking skills needed to tackle real-world challenges.

2.2.3 INSPIRE

We inspire others by leading with integrity, compassion, and a commitment to service. Through mentorship, community outreach, and sharing our knowledge, we empower students of all ages to pursue STEM, develop leadership skills, and create a lasting impact in their schools, communities, and beyond.



3. TEAM DIRECTORY

3.1 STUDENT LEADERSHIP

Student Leadership consists of all subteam leads and the three captains. Student Leadership meets every week to coordinate upcoming events, review team progress, plan for the next few weeks, and address any issues or improvements for the team. The Student Leadership for 2026-2027 includes:

- **Aman Ehan (Co-Captain)**
- **Safa Taj (Co-Captain)**
- **Lucjan Ambrozej (Co-Captain)**

All Student Leadership positions will be held by students entering grades 10-12 who were members of the team last year. If there are no eligible candidates, exceptions may be made. Student Leadership reserves the right to remove a student for repeated or severe violations of team guidelines or for being incapable or unwilling to carry out the duties or responsibilities associated with their assigned role.

3.2 COACHES

Most coach one or two subteams and are here to teach, guide, and lead alongside the students. Coaches are integral to the success of our team. Our coaches for the 2026 - 2027 season include:

- **Isaiah Wilson (Year 9)**
- **Mostafa (Year 6)**
- **Sheikh (Year 6)**
- **Nikhil (Year 5)**

3.3 TEAM DIVISIONS

Our team is split into six primary subteams: Mechanical, Design, Electrical, Software, Finance, Marketing, Outreach, and Strategy.

- **Mechanical**
 - Builds, and maintains robot's physical component's and mechanisms while optimizing performance.
- **Design**
 - Develops and refines robot CAD models to ensure accuracy, streamline assembly, and support seamless system integration.
- **Electrical**
 - Builds electrical systems including wiring, power distribution, and sensor systems to for reliable operation.
- **Software**
 - Develop robot software controls and logic. Works on autonomous routines and system integration.



3. TEAM DIRECTORY

- **Finance**
 - Manage's team's budget and financial planning. track expenses and pursues grants and sponsorships.
- **Marketing**
 - Build's the teams brand, promotes our mision. creates content, manages social media, and shows our impact.
- **Outreach**
 - Connects with our community to inspire and educate. Leads events, mentors students, and parteners with others.
- **Strategy**
 - Analyzes match data, develops game strategies, and makes real-time decisions to maximize scoring and ranking performance.

3.3.1 SUBTEAM ALLOCATION

On the team application form, students are asked to rank the subteams they are most interested in joining. We make every effort to place each student on their highest-ranked preference whenever possible while considering team needs and maintaining balanced subteam sizes.

3.3.2 CROSS-TEAM ASSIGNMENT

In addition to being assigned to a primary subteam, members may be asked to assist other subteams throughout the season as needed. These cross-team assignments help maintain efficiency, encourage collaboration, and ensure that all areas of the team have the support they need to meet deadlines and achieve shared goals.

3.4 TEAM CONTRACTS

If you have any questions, concerns, suggestions, or need assistance, please reach out to the appropriate team contact. We encourage all members to communicate openly and respectfully, whether they need help, have feedback, or would like to discuss an issue. Addressing concerns early allows us to resolve problems more effectively, improve the team experience, and ensure every member feels supported. No concern is too small, and we are always happy to listen and help whenever possible.

- **Isaiah** - email
- **Mostafa** - email
- **Sheikh** - email
- **Nikhil** - email
- **Aman Ehan** - email
- **Safa Taj** - email
- **Lucjan Ambrozej** - email
- **Nox Headquarters** - email



4. STUDENT EXPECTATIONS

4.1 ATTENDANCE POLICY

4.1.1 ATTENDANCE REQUIREMENTS

Attendance will be taken throughout the season to make sure members are actively participating and attending all meetings, build sessions, and events. They are also expected to notify a team leader if they will not be present. It is important for attendance and to be on time, so projects do not get behind schedule or members fall behind with their work. These are the following criteria for attendance:

- **Present**
 - The member attends the meeting or event on time, participates actively, and remains engaged for the duration of the session.
- **Excused Absence**
 - The member is unable to attend but informs a team leader in advance with a valid reason.
- **Unexcused Absence**
 - The member does not attend a required meeting or event and fails to notify a team leader beforehand.
- **Unproductive**
 - The member is present but is not actively contributing, participating, or working on assigned tasks without a valid reason.

4.1.2 TEAM EVALUATIONS

At the end of every month, members will be checked to see if they are still active and working for the team or not. Those with lower than 70% attendance for the month may be put on probation. Those who are under 70% will be notified by a member of Student Leadership as a warning. If a member is continually unsatisfactory in their attendance, they may get kicked off the team, the decision solely up to Student Leadership, monthly throughout the offseason and competition season.

4.1.3 ABSENCE ACCOMODATIONS

At the end of every month, members will be checked to see if they are still active and working for the team or not. Those with lower than 70% attendance for the month may be put on probation. Those who are under 70% will be notified by a member of Student Leadership as a warning. If a member is continually unsatisfactory in their attendance, they may get kicked off the team, the decision solely up to Student Leadership, monthly throughout the offseason and competition season.

Dismissal from the team may also be considered for reasons beyond attendance. Reasons may include, but are not limited to:

- Unacceptable behavior
- Lack of initiative
- Poor work ethic
- Negative contribution to the team environment



4. STUDENT EXPECTATIONS

4.2 CODE OF CONDUCT

Student conduct must adhere to all applicable school, local, state, and federal laws, regulations, and policies relating to harassment, bullying, discrimination, and unsafe conditions. This applies both within the school or at a team event, or through online communication among team members. Students must also abide by all team specific expectations.

4.2.1 AT ALL TIMES

As a team member, you represent our team, community, and sponsors wherever you go. Your words, actions, and behavior reflect on the entire organization, whether at meetings, competitions, outreach events, or in public spaces. Members are expected to act with respect, professionalism, and integrity at all times, as their actions contribute to the team's reputation and image.

4.2.2 MEETINGS

During team meetings, members are expected to be respectful, participate, and be productive. Students are to actively participate and work with each other to get their tasks done in the time allotted. Members are to keep the group together, and follow directions from their team leaders.

4.2.3 VIRTUAL

The members of the team are expected to act professionally and respectfully towards each other both inside and outside of work in all mediums of communication including team chats, meetings, etc. They must refrain from acting out inappropriately online and uphold the image of the group. The standards of behavior for this team will be upheld in all digital mediums, as they would be in person.

4.2.4 COMPETITIONS

During competitions, members are expected to conduct themselves in a manner that reflects credit and courtesy to the team. Students are expected to encourage teammates, exhibit courtesy to other teams and volunteers, and follow event rules and guidelines. Members should always be mindful that their actions can reflect on the team and the organization and therefore should act in a positive manner at all times.

4.2.5 REPORTING MISCONDUCT

Team members are expected to communicate with each other appropriately in any virtual platforms, including personal messaging, team chats, online meetings, and other modes of communication utilized by the group. Each member must demonstrate professionalism and participation in the interaction and uphold positive behavior in any digital space engaging the group. Communication in virtual platforms can affect the organization, and thus each team member must uphold proper decorum when interacting with another member online. Members should treat others how they would in person, so as to ensure that everyone is respected and included. Misconduct through the team communication channels would result in disciplinary action.



4. STUDENT EXPECTATIONS

4.3 TEAM DRESS CODE

All students are expected to follow the team dress code when entering workshops, attending meetings, or participating in any competitions or team events. This includes, but is not limited to, the following requirements:

- Students must wear clothing that fully covers undergarments and private areas.
- Students may not wear clothing or accessories that display violence, obscenity, pornography, nudity, or sexual content in any form.
- Students may not wear clothing or accessories that promote hate speech or discrimination against individuals or groups based on race, ethnicity, gender, sexual orientation, gender identity, religion, or any other protected characteristic.

In addition, students must follow these workshops safety requirements

- In addition, students must follow these workshop safety requirements:
- Long hair must be securely tied back whenever working in the workshop or around machinery.
- Jewelry is not permitted if it poses a risk of becoming caught in robot components or machinery, and wearing jewelry is generally discouraged while participating in team activities.
- Closed-toe shoes must be worn at all times in the workshop, during build activities, and at competitions where required.

4.3.1 TEAM APPAREL

When wearing a team shirt or any piece of team apparel, you are representing the team, our sponsors, and our community regardless of where you are. Students are expected to act appropriately and professionally while wearing team apparel, as their actions reflect on the entire organization.

Team apparel may not be noticeably altered or damaged. Minor adjustments, such as tailoring an oversized shirt to improve fit, are permitted; however, modifications such as cutting off sleeves, changing the neckline, or altering/damaging team logos are not allowed.

4.3.2 AT COMPETITION

At competitions, it is important for the team to maintain a unified and professional appearance. All team members attending as part of the team should wear team apparel when provided or applicable, and may also wear other team-approved items such as sweatshirts, hats, windbreakers, or additional merchandise. On practice days, the team may choose to relax these expectations, and any changes or exceptions will be communicated to the travel team before each competition.

Because competitions often require travel away from home, students are held to a high standard of conduct. Serious behavior violations may result in removal from the event, with transportation home arranged at the family's expense. The field trip administrator has final authority over consequences and competition participation and may be blacklisted from going to any overnight trips.



4. STUDENT EXPECTATIONS

4.3.3 OTHER EVENTS

Fundraisers or other off-season events may have modified dress codes than regionals and the championship. Team members who have team apparel are strongly encouraged to wear it while those who do not can still join. If there is an important event, a dress code must be proposed and announced to the members beforehand.

4.4 TRAINING PROGRAM

Each subteam has a set of required training standards that members must complete before the start of build season. Failure to meet these standards may result in removal from the team.

4.5 CORRECTIVE ACTION

Violations previously mentioned will be handled by a progressive discipline system that considers how seriously the student is likely to take the problem, his or her efforts to correct it, and whether there is a pattern of such incidents.

- **Initial Violation** - Based on the investigation results, reports, and interviews, Core Leadership will arrange a meeting with the student to review and/or discuss the nature of the violation, and determine a suitable disciplinary resolution. For bullying, harassment, and discrimination complaints, a mediation or reconciliation session will be considered and conducted, if applicable.
- **Second Violation** - If an individual or group of individuals are found to be violating any of the policies and/or rules repeatedly or if the student is not taking the appropriate actions to address the initial conflict, a meeting can be held with the student, his/her parent/guardian, and Core Leadership to address the issue. Possible consequences include a temporary suspension from team activities or a removal from a leadership or responsibility position.
- **Third Violation** - If misbehavior continues after the two meetings, you may be dismissed from the team with the approval of the representatives. Dismissal from the team is a permanent action for the entire school year. You may try out again next year, but you might have to have another meeting to talk about your behavior and acknowledge it.

4.6 ACCOUNTABILITY

Student Advocate issues will be addressed and resolved. Coach-related problems will be solved to enhance relationships, whereas student conflicts will be managed by coaches and the administration while maintaining the reporter's anonymous.

4.7 ACADEMIC STANDARDS

To participate in the program, students must maintain a minimum overall grade average of 70%. Report cards will be reviewed anonymously each semester to ensure students continue to meet the academic expectations of the team.



5. WORKSPACE RULES

To maintain a safe, organized, and productive workspace, all team members are expected to follow these rules and Dress Code rules located in **Section 4.3**:

1. **Equipment Usage**: Borrowing team equipment outside of meetings requires approval from a team captain responsible for that equipment.
2. **Safety First**: All safety guidelines and protocols must be followed at all times. Workspace tools and machinery (CNC) may only be used by students who have completed the required training and been approved by **NYCFIRST** to operate them.
3. **Tool Organization**: All tools and equipment must be returned to their designated locations after use whether it be ours or the Stem Centers.
4. **Leaving Meetings Early**: Students who need to leave before the end of a meeting must provide appropriate notice and receive permission from their subteam lead. Students must also assist with cleanup before leaving.
5. **Computer Usage**: Programs or software may not be downloaded or installed on programming, CAD, or business/media computers without approval from the appropriate subteam lead and a clear connection to team activities.
6. **Clean 15**: The final 15 minutes of every session will be dedicated to cleanup. All members present are expected to help restore the workspace. Students who remain after the official meeting time must continue to keep their workspace clean.
7. **Personal Equipment**: Students are responsible for any personal equipment or belongings they bring to team meetings or events. The team is not responsible for lost, damaged, or stolen personal items. All personal equipment must comply with school and team rules.
8. **Respect the Workspace**: Keep all work areas clean, organized, and free of unnecessary clutter. Treat team facilities, equipment, and other members' belongings with respect.
9. **Report Damage**: Any damaged, lost, or malfunctioning equipment must be reported immediately to a coach or team leader. Do not attempt repairs on equipment unless authorized.
10. **Food and Drinks**: Food and drinks must be kept away from tools, electronics, robots, and other sensitive equipment unless specifically permitted.
11. **Proper Conduct**: Students must maintain a respectful and productive environment. Horseplay, unsafe behavior, or actions that interfere with others' work are not permitted.
12. **Project Responsibility**: Students are responsible for properly documenting, storing, and maintaining the work they complete. Any important changes, designs, files, or updates should be communicated to the appropriate subteam members to ensure continuity and organization.
13. **Clean As You Go**: Students are expected to clean their workspace throughout the meeting, not only during the Clean 15. Materials, tools, and parts should not be left unattended or create unnecessary hazards.
14. **Material Usage**: Team materials and supplies should be used responsibly. Do not use other team's parts or material without their permission.



6. TRAVEL PROCEDURES

6.1 TEAM TRAVEL ELIGIBILITY

For all team events, a Travel Team will be selected by Core Leadership based on the established Travel Team criteria. Members are chosen based on their ability to represent the team professionally and fulfill all **Student Expectations**, which are required for their competition roles. Travel Team selections will be announced at least one and a half weeks before each event to allow time for paperwork and logistics. The Travel Team will be re-evaluated before each competition, considering previous event performance, behavior, and overall participation both during and outside of meetings. Team members must notify Core Leadership of any known competition conflicts before Travel Team selection begins. Exceptions may be made for emergencies.

6.2 TEAM TRAVEL ROLES

The Travel Team members are positions selected by the Core Leadership based on their qualifications under the criteria of the Travel Team requirements. For each event and according to the specific competition requirements, one student can fill several positions, and both the staff and team size can be changed. Members should be chosen based on the ability to represent the travel team, the responsibility they demonstrate in their work, focus, communication skills, and high performance.

Team Captains

- Communicate logistics between students, mentors, parents, and coordinators.
- Ensure all students are accounted for during competitions.
- Fulfill additional competition responsibilities.

Drive Team

- Commit to role practices and competition responsibilities.
- Assist the Pit Crew with diagnosing and repairing robot issues.

Pit Crew (Mechanical, Electrical, Programming, Judging)

- Diagnose and repair robot issues between matches.
- Support other teams when possible.
- Pit Crew will involve rotations between qualified members

Strategist

- Develop match strategies by communicating with alliance teams.
- Relay strategies to the Drive Coach.
- Analyze matches and contribute to the team picklist.
- Provide recommendations to the Match Strategist.

Scouters

- Members who have no role or aren't currently working become scouts
- Manage scouting operations, systems, and personnel.
- Support scout organization and safety.
- Watch matches to record opponents strategies



6. TRAVEL PROCEDURES

6.3 TEAM TRAVEL SELECTION

The Travel Team selection process is student-based and takes into account recommendations from subteam leads, coaches, and Core Leadership. Before competitions, subteam leads are responsible for nominating students for competition roles based on skill, performance, and general ability to uphold Travel Team standards. Travel Team Core Leadership will then review nominations and choose students they feel are best fit for the competition roles they have nominated for. The Drive Team selection process is student-based and determined solely by the Head Coach.

6.4 TEAM TRAVEL CODE OF CONDUCT

Captains only are exceptions for room check. All students are required to be in their assigned room by curfew, and are not allowed to leave until the breakfast or departure time unless there is an emergency and they have notified a coach. Curfew is 10:00 PM, unless otherwise announced in competition meetings.

1. **Professional Representation:** Students must act respectfully and professionally at all times. Remember that your actions reflect on the team, sponsors, schools, and community.
2. **Follow Chaperone Instructions:** Students must follow all instructions and expectations set by coaches, mentors, and chaperones. Their decisions regarding safety, schedules, and conduct are final.
3. **Room Expectations:** Students are responsible for keeping their rooms clean, respecting hotel property, and maintaining appropriate behavior. Any damage or misconduct may result in disciplinary action.
4. **Attendance and Punctuality:** Students must arrive on time for all scheduled activities, including meals, meetings, matches, and transportation.
5. **Travel Expectations:** Students must remain with the team during scheduled travel and may not separate from the group without approval from a coach or chaperone.
6. **Respect Others:** Students must treat teammates, mentors, volunteers, hotel staff, other teams, and members of the public with respect and kindness.
7. **Substance-Free Environment:** The use, possession, or distribution of alcohol, drugs, nicotine products, or other prohibited substances is not allowed.
8. **Social Media Conduct:** Students must ensure that posts, photos, and online activity during team trips represent the team positively and do not violate team expectations or the privacy of others.
9. **Safety First:** Students must follow all safety procedures during travel, hotel stays, competitions, and team activities. Unsafe behavior or horseplay is not permitted.
10. **Meals and Shared Spaces:** Students must be respectful in shared areas, follow meal schedules, and help maintain clean and organized spaces.
11. **Personal Responsibility:** Students are responsible for their belongings, actions, and decisions throughout the trip. The team is not responsible for lost or damaged personal items.



7. VOLUNTEERING

Volunteering at FIRST events gives back to the robotics community while representing our team. Students are expected to uphold the values of Gracious Professionalism and Coopertition.

Students volunteering at FIRST events are expected to:

- **Represent the Team Professionally:** Students must maintain a positive attitude, demonstrate respect, and act professionally at all times. Their behavior should reflect positively on the team, sponsors, and the FIRST community.
- **Arrive Prepared and On Time:** Students must arrive at the assigned time, attend any required volunteer meetings or trainings, and come prepared with any necessary materials or equipment.
- **Follow Volunteer Leadership:** Students must follow directions from event coordinators, lead volunteers, and staff members. If unsure about a task, students should ask questions rather than make assumptions.
- **Complete Assigned Responsibilities:** Students are expected to remain engaged with their assigned role and complete tasks to the best of their ability. Leaving a volunteer position without permission or failing to complete responsibilities is not acceptable.
- **Support Other Teams:** Volunteers should create a welcoming environment for all participants by assisting teams, answering questions when appropriate, and helping others succeed.
- **Practice Gracious Professionalism:** Students should be respectful, patient, and encouraging when interacting with teams, volunteers, judges, referees, and event staff. Competitive success should never come at the expense of kindness and respect.
- **Maintain Safety Awareness:** Students must follow all event safety procedures, remain aware of their surroundings, and immediately report hazards or concerns to event staff.
- **Communicate Clearly:** Students should communicate respectfully with other volunteers and staff, provide updates when issues arise, and ask for clarification when needed.
- **Stay Focused and Engaged:** Personal distractions, excessive phone use, or behavior that prevents students from completing their responsibilities should be avoided while volunteering.
- **Respect Event Equipment and Facilities:** All equipment, materials, and facilities used during volunteering must be treated with care and returned or left in proper condition.

7.1 MANDATORY VOLUNTEERING

To remain eligible for Travel Team selection, all students must complete four volunteer events each season for example but not limited to:

- 2 FIRST LEGO League (FLL) events
- 2 FIRST Tech Challenge (FTC) events

Volunteer service must be completed as approved in order for the student to participate in an event. Students who fail to do so before the Travel Team selection will not be permitted to travel except as determined by the Core Leadership.



8. MEETINGS

8.1 MEETING SCHEDULE

Nox conducts mandatory team meetings two days every week, most often on a Friday and Saturday. Any changes to the meeting schedule will be announced ahead of time. Attendance, as well as contribution and participation are mandatory, and will be taken into consideration for continued team membership or the ability to play on the Travel Team. Failure to attend and participate in team meetings without an acceptable reason may lead to removal from the team or denial of participation on the Travel Team.

Offseason: Early May - Late August

- The offseason focuses on skill development, team growth, and preparation for the upcoming season. Members are expected to:
 - Complete an offseason project.
 - Attend lessons and technical training.
 - Teach and mentor newer members.
 - Participate in recruitment and outreach events.
 - Organize and maintain the workshop and team equipment.

Build Season: Early September - Early March

- Build Season is focused on designing, building, testing, and preparing the robot for competition. Members are expected to:
 - Attend meetings consistently and contribute to their subteam.
 - Design, build, program, test, and refine the robot.
 - Complete assigned tasks and meet project deadlines.
 - Collaborate with other subteams throughout the season.
 - Participate in robot testing, practice, and competition preparation.

FTC Competition Season: Mid November - Early March

- During the FTC Competition Season, members focus on preparing for and competing in FIRST Tech Challenge events. Members are expected to:
 - Attend FTC meetings, practices, and competitions.
 - Contribute to robot development, testing, and strategy.
 - Represent the team professionally at competitions.
 - Assist with scouting, pit operations, and team responsibilities.

FRC Competition Season: Early March - Early May

- During the FRC Competition Season, members apply the skills developed throughout the offseason by competing, improving the robot, and representing the team. Members are expected to:
 - Attend FTC meetings, practices, and competitions.
 - Continue developing and improving the robot throughout the season.
 - Contribute to strategy, scouting, and pit operations.
 - Demonstrate professionalism and Gracious Professionalism at all events.



8. MEETINGS

8.2 SEASON BEACON

FTC Kickoff

- Official launch of the FIRST Tech Challenge season, where the annual game is revealed and teams begin planning and robot development.
- **Date:** Early September

Robo-Replay

- An FRC offseason competition where teams gain additional match experience, test robot improvements, and prepare for the upcoming season.
- **Date & Location:** October 10–11 • John Dewey High School, Brooklyn, NY

FTC Qualifiers

- Local qualifying tournaments where teams compete for advancement to the Super Qualifiers.
- **Date & Location:** November–February • Various venues throughout New York City

FRC Kickoff

- Official launch of the FIRST Robotics Competition season, featuring the annual game reveal and start of robot design.
- **Date:** Early January

FTC Super-Qualifiers

- Regional advancement event for top-performing FTC teams to advance to NYC Championship.
- **Date:** Late February • John Dewey High School, Brooklyn, NY

FTC NYC Championship

- FTC NYC Championship: Championship event for the top FTC teams in New York City to advance to World Championship.
- **Date & Location:** Early March • Francis Lewis High School, Fresh Meadows, Queens, NY

Greater Pittsburgh Regional

- Official FIRST Robotics Competition Week 3 regional event.
- **Date & Location:** Mid-March • David L. Lawrence Convention Center, Pittsburgh, PA

Gotham Regional

- Official FIRST Robotics Competition Week 5 regional event
- **Date & Location:** Early April • Fort Washington Armory, New York, NY

Tech Valley Regional

- Official FIRST Robotics Competition Week 7 regional event
- **Date & Location:** Mid-April • MVP Arena, Albany, NY

FIRST World Championship

- International championship where the top FRC and FTC teams compete.
- **Date & Location:** Late April • George R. Brown Convention Center, Houston, TX



9. MEDIA SHARING POLICY

9.1 MEDIA COMPLIANCE ACTS

Media compliance is making sure all photos/videos/etc. that are shared by Nox are compliant with privacy, copyright and other standards. Members must also have appropriate permission if they post anything about another person, and cannot post anything that might be inappropriate, secret, or damaging to any of the teams or sponsors. All photos/videos/etc. must reflect positively on the Nox team and our FIRST community.

9.1.1 ACT 1: AUTHORIZED MEDIA SHARING

Authorized media sharing ensures that the photos and videos are approved, appropriate, and representative of Nox. The team social media should be used to promote and highlight the team, its achievements, and its activities, while respecting the privacy of its members.

- Only share team media through approved platforms or with permission from the Captains.
- Ensure all posted content positively represents Nox, sponsors, and the FIRST community.
- Avoid sharing private information, inappropriate content, or media that could harm the reputation of the team.
- Obtain permission before posting photos or videos of other team members.
- Follow all copyright and usage guidelines when using external media.

9.1.2 ACT 2: PRIVACY & CONSENT

Privacy and consent ensure that all members of Nox have control of how their image, information, and other material are used.

- Obtain consent before sharing photos, videos, or personal information of others.
- Respect a member's request to remove or not share specific media.
- Avoid sharing private team discussions, documents, or information without approval.
- Do not record or publish content involving others without appropriate permission.
- Protect the privacy and safety of all team members, mentors, and community members.

9.1.3 ACT 3: PROFESSIONAL DIGITAL PRESENCE

Maintaining a professional digital presence ensures that Nox is represented positively online. All members are responsible for how their online actions and shared content reflect on themselves, the team, sponsors, and the FIRST community.

- Represent Nox positively on all social media platforms and online spaces.
- Avoid posting inappropriate, offensive, or harmful content while associated with the team.
- Follow team branding, communication, and media guidelines.
- Protect confidential team information, including designs, strategies, and internal discussions.
- Use respectful and professional language when communicating online.



10. CONTRACTS

10.1 MEDIA CONSENT FORM

The Media Consent Agreement permits FRC Team 11702 Nox to use the subjects' photos, video, interviews, quotes, and other media for non-profit purposes, such as recruiting, promoting, and sharing stories, accomplishments and experience of our team members. By signing this form, every team member allows Nox to feature them in any media type so that the team can spread the word about its outreach in the field of STEM education and share its story with the FIRST community and a larger audience.

10.2 STUDENT CONTRACT

The Student Contract is what establishes the expectations, responsibilities, and what is owed by the staff and members of FRC Team 11702 Nox. The contract is signed to demonstrate the understanding of what is owed by all Nox members, and what the standards are that must be upheld for a safe and respectful workplace to allow all members of Nox to thrive in the team environment, allowing Nox to carry out its mission and objectives. The Student Contract serves to establish standards of conduct, and expectations of participation from members in order to allow Nox to function efficiently throughout the season, as well as set standards of what should be upheld as a code of conduct for both the members and the staff in order for Nox to remain a reputable and trustworthy team. By signing the Student Contract, members accept responsibility for their actions, and acknowledge the values of Nox.

10.3 FINAL NOTES

We expect each member to read through, understand, and abide by all rules, expectations, and policies stated in this handbook. Core leadership retains the right to decide punishments for major violations of this handbook, take into account any confidential information regarding situations in which they are involved, and to modify this handbook as necessary throughout the season. All changes will be communicated to their respective teams by the Core Leadership. Our students' success, growth, and ability to create a positive environment is our number one priority and we are excited to achieve that with all of you. We really appreciate your commitment and responsibility to make our team great!

10.4 TEAM CONTACTS

Isaiah - email - phone number
Mostafa - email - phone number
Sheikh - email - phone number
Nikhil - email - phone number
Aman Ehan - email - phone number
Safa Taj - email - phone number
Lucjan Ambrozej - email - phone number
Nox Headquarters - email - phone number